

John Escobedo

Customer Service Specialist | De-escalation & Account Recovery | Trilingual (English/Spanish/ASL)

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(512) 299-3269

Austin, Texas

Summary: Customer service professional with 20+ years supporting people across gaming, healthcare, government, and live events. Frontline roles at Blizzard Entertainment and Linden Lab taught me to stay calm with upset users and resolve complex problems through patient listening and clear communication, a mindset I carried into UAT leadership and user research on VA healthcare and Deaf accessibility platforms. Trilingual communicator (English, Spanish, ASL) who builds rapport with diverse audiences in person, by phone, and online.

SKILLS

Customer Support: High-Touch & High-Volume Support, De-escalation & Conflict Resolution, Account Recovery, Live Chat & Ticket Systems (Parature), Active Listening & Empathetic Communication, Trust & Safety (Fraud & Exploit Investigation), Technical Troubleshooting & Incident Response

Accessibility & Inclusion: Section 508 & WCAG, JAWS & NVDA Screen Readers, Inclusive User Research, End-User Advocacy, Deaf Cultural Competency & ASL (Conversational)

Office & Creative Software: Office 365 (Teams, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook), Google Workspace (Drive, Docs, Sheets), Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects), Canva, GIMP

Live Events & A/V: Live Sound Engineering & Mixing, A/V Setup & Strike, Music Programming & Live Cueing, Performer & Client Coordination, Hosting & MC, Crowd Engagement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Tester (Volunteer)

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performed exploratory testing on a new web application, found silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, and contributed fixes and documentation directly to the codebase.

- Ran end-to-end exploratory testing across browsers and platforms, validating full user workflows.
- Caught silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, including cases where the app returned blank responses with no error signal.
- Built a custom failure-report template so any reader, technical or not, could immediately see what broke.

Karaoke Host

Freelance | Austin, TX

July 2025 to Present

Hosted live karaoke events, running sound and software while managing the room and adapting the flow to the crowd.

- Ran event flow and timing, adjusting live to audience requests and room energy.
- Juggled the song queue, timing, and room energy to keep the night moving.
- Handled sound systems, karaoke software, and on-the-fly troubleshooting so events ran without interruption.
- Kept the atmosphere welcoming so first-timers felt comfortable stepping up alongside regulars.

Robot Tele-Operator

Apptronik (via Insight Global) | Austin, TX
July 2025 to September 2025

Tested and documented humanoid robot behavior for Apptronik, writing procedures and bug reports engineering could act on directly.

- Cut physical test setup time by 75% by standardizing the preparation pattern, giving data collection consistent, repeatable conditions.
- Turned observed robot behaviors into clear bug reports engineering could act on immediately.
- Wrote startup, shutdown, and emergency shutdown procedures for 2 robot models where none existed, cutting new-tester ramp-up time by roughly 50% and becoming the team standard.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL
March 2019 to June 2025

Led QA, UAT, and requirements analysis across multiple VA healthcare projects, drove Agile process adoption, and served as SME for complex clinical modules.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions so cross-functional teams could navigate the clinical requirements.
- Drove the Waterfall-to-Agile transition, introducing code freeze and release-candidate practices that shifted teams from reactive firefighting to predictable delivery.
- Managed test cases, defects, requirements documentation, and project dashboards in JIRA and Confluence across 6+ years and multiple VA projects.
- Ran SOAP API testing on VA home loan .NET applications and REST API testing via Postman on Java healthcare modules, validating service queries, data contracts, and data integrity.
- Built and executed test strategies for VA clinical healthcare applications across .NET and Java, covering UAT, regression, integration, smoke, sanity, end-to-end, and 508 compliance.
- Conducted user acceptance testing during two separate periods, organizing the testers, creating the tests, and gathering the results.
- Led 508 compliance initiatives and performed hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation on VA clinical interfaces, catching accessibility issues visual inspection misses.
- Partnered with automation engineers to validate Cucumber and Selenium scripts, catching requirement-to-execution gaps before tests went into rotation.
- Built requirements traceability documentation mapping every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile.

DJ

Freelance | Austin, TX
January 2011 to April 2012

DJed dance events across Austin, working with venues and matching music to each event's tone and crowd.

- Built setlists for Danceversity, Dance International, and Synergy Dance Studio based on event style and audience preferences.
- Adapted to different in-house sound systems and venue quirks on the fly.
- Coordinated with event organizers to match music to the tone and timing of each event.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX
June 2018 to October 2018

Established QA processes and JIRA workflows from the ground up for a health tech startup's secure patient portal, partnering with engineering and product leadership on release validation.

- As JIRA administrator, designed a unified workflow with custom issue types, permission schemes, notifications, and dashboards, giving engineering and product real-time visibility into release status.
- Defined the initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, bringing predictability to a fast-moving startup.
- Assessed release risk and delivered go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed to market with quality.
- Validated releases across major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX
July 2017 to June 2018

As sole QA, built quality processes and test infrastructure from zero for the flagship education assessment platform, earning trust with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices, including version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation, to a team shipping without formal QA process, integrating quality as a respected part of the SDLC.
- Created end-to-end test and product documentation covering procedures, requirements traceability, verification standards, and feature release notes.
- Standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity between developers and QA and speeding up delivery.
- Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.

QA Tester | QA Analyst

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX
May 2015 to May 2017

QA Analyst contracted to RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team testing for high-visibility e-commerce launches and aligning test priorities with business needs.

- Coordinated QA across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning test priorities with leadership expectations.
- Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity across the product.
- Triaged live production issues under pressure, communicating status updates to leadership during outages.
- Partnered with developers to improve internal tooling and CI/CD workflow, contributing changes that increased team efficiency.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

Communication Services for the Deaf | Austin, TX
May 2013 to January 2015

Built the QA function for a video interpreting platform serving Deaf and hard-of-hearing users, immersing in the community to shape testing around real user needs.

- Learned American Sign Language and Deaf cultural norms to understand user needs firsthand, using that immersion as a user research approach that shaped requirements validation.
- Established the company's first-ever QA function, defining test procedures and quality benchmarks that caught non-functional code blocking release.

- Owned validation across web and mobile, from test planning through stakeholder reporting.
- Expanded test coverage to previously unreachable environments by implementing a VirtualBox-based cross-platform solution.

Lead QA Tester | Quality Assurance Tester

DocbookMD | Austin, TX

July 2012 to April 2013

Founded the QA function for a HIPAA-compliant healthcare messaging app, establishing regulatory-grade quality processes and validation strategy from zero.

- Analyzed and documented HIPAA compliance requirements, ensuring the app met regulatory standards for secure transmission of patient health information.
- Built the initial test strategy and QA documentation from scratch, gating releases against both business and HIPAA compliance requirements.
- Ran functional, regression, and HIPAA compliance validation across all supported mobile devices, creatively simulating wifi outages to catch edge cases scripted testing misses.

Event Coordinator and Host

Kick Butt Coffee | Austin, TX

January 2011 to April 2012

Organized and ran weekly dance events, handling vendors, tech setup, and community promotion.

- Ran weekly events, coordinating DJs, venue logistics, and crowd engagement.
- Set up audio and event tech to integrate with the venue's house sound system.
- Ran event promotion and community outreach through social media.

Game Master | Customer Experience & Trust Specialist

Blizzard Entertainment | Austin, TX

July 2010 to July 2011

Delivered high-touch customer support for World of Warcraft, analyzing complex cases and documenting findings for development teams while maintaining user trust in a high-volume environment.

- Analyzed and documented fraud and exploitation cases, delivering detailed root cause reports to development teams.
- De-escalated emotionally charged escalations through patient listening, restoring lost items and accounts and turning frustrated users into loyal ones.
- Delivered high-volume support via live chat and ticket systems, balancing efficiency with genuine care.
- Restored compromised accounts with precision, following strict security and data integrity protocols.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Analyst | Support Tools Developer | Community Operations, *Linden Lab* (2007–2010)

Executive Assistant, *LOC Consultants* (2005–2006)

Receptionist, *GoDance Studios* (2005–2005)

Building Monitor, *UT Performing Arts Center* (2004–2004)

Digital Artist / Webmaster, *Computer Discovery Center* (2002–2004)

Minister / Web Master, *Weddings Performed* (2002–2003)

EDUCATION

Austin Community College - Austin, TX

Certificate in American Sign Language
2015 – 2017

ASL School - Austin, TX

Certificate in American Sign Language
2008 – 2012

Vista College - Berkeley, CA

Video Editing and Life Drawing
2001 – 2002

A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max
1995 – 1996

San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX

Computer Science, Fine Art
1993 – 1995

Online version: <https://johnesco.github.io/resume>